

Unit: 1

A. Evolution and growth of internet - Development of information and communication technology and its impact on media, Internet penetration in India:

1. Definition:

- **Internet:** The internet is a global network that connects millions of computers and allows people to share information, communicate, and access various services.
 - **ICT (Information and Communication Technology):** ICT means all the technologies used for handling information and communication, like computers, mobile phones, the internet, television, and radio.
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2. Evolution and Growth of Internet:

- The internet began as a U.S. government project called **ARPANET** in the late 1960s.
 - In the 1990s, it became available for public use.
 - Over time, the speed and quality of the internet improved – from **dial-up** to **broadband**, **4G**, and now **5G**.
 - Internet became cheaper and available even in remote areas.
 - Social media, online shopping, digital payments, e-learning, and video streaming grew because of internet expansion.
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Key Points:

- **1995** – Internet services started in India by VSNL (Videsh Sanchar Nigam Limited).
 - **2000s** – Broadband connections and cyber cafes became popular.
 - **2016 onwards** – Mobile internet (especially after Jio's launch) changed everything.
 - **Today** – Internet is used in daily life for education, work, communication, banking, and entertainment.
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3. Development of ICT and Its Impact on Media:

- ICT tools like **computers, internet, smartphones, apps** have changed how news is created, shared, and received.
 - Traditional media like **newspapers, radio, TV** now use online platforms (websites, apps, YouTube).
 - Rise of **digital journalism, citizen journalism, and social media influencers**.
 - Fast communication, live updates, and user participation became possible.
 - Journalists use tools like emails, WhatsApp, Zoom, Google Docs for reporting and editing.
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Key Points:

- **Faster communication** and real-time news sharing.
 - **Media convergence** – newspapers now have websites, YouTube channels, and social media pages.
 - **24×7 news cycle** – media is no longer limited to morning/evening bulletins.
 - **More interaction** – readers/viewers can comment, share, and report news.
 - **Fake news** and **misinformation** are also big challenges in digital media.
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4. Internet Penetration in India:

- **Internet penetration** means how much of the population has access to the internet.
 - As of 2024, India has **over 850 million internet users**.
 - **Urban areas** have higher internet usage, but rural areas are catching up fast.
 - Government programs like **Digital India, BharatNet**, and cheap mobile data helped in fast growth.
 - Youth and students are the largest group of internet users in India.
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Key Points:

- India is the **second-largest internet user** country in the world after China.
 - **Smartphones and cheap data** made internet affordable.
 - **Online education, banking, and shopping** are growing fast in rural areas.
 - Internet also helped in **government schemes, telemedicine, and online job applications**.
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5. Example:

- In Malda district of West Bengal, many students now use YouTube and online apps like Byju's for studies.
 - Local news platforms like "**Khabar Setu**" can reach people instantly using WhatsApp, Facebook, or websites.
 - Farmers can get **weather updates and mandi prices** online through apps provided by the government.
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Conclusion:

The internet and ICT have changed our life deeply. The way we get news, study, work, or do business is now fast and digital. In a country like India, the growth of internet is helping bridge the gap between rural and urban areas. But we must also fight challenges like fake news and digital addiction.

B. Nature of the web – Revolutionary change in communication, Big Data, unparalleled benefits of the net and social media, Largest ungoverned space on earth, Dark Net:

1. Definition:

- **Web (World Wide Web):** The web is a system of connected documents and websites on the internet. People use it to browse, read, watch, and interact online using web browsers like Chrome, Firefox, or Safari.
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2. Nature of the Web:

- The web is **open, global, digital, fast, and interactive**.
 - It allows **anyone to access or share information** from anywhere in the world.
 - It is **always evolving**, from Web 1.0 (static pages), to Web 2.0 (interactive, social media), and now moving to Web 3.0 (smart, AI-based).
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3. Revolutionary Change in Communication:

- **Old way:** Letters, landline phones, newspapers, face-to-face meetings.
 - **New way:** Emails, WhatsApp, Facebook, Zoom, YouTube, and blogs.
 - Communication is now **instant, global, multimedia-based**, and two-way.
 - People can create and share content, not just receive it.
 - News breaks in seconds through social media like X (Twitter) or Instagram.
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Key Points:

- News and messages spread faster than ever.
 - People across countries can talk for free.
 - Digital platforms give **voice to common people**.
 - Education, jobs, health services are now just one click away.
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4. Big Data:

- **Big Data** means a very large amount of data that is collected and analyzed.
 - Every click, like, search, and video watched creates data.
 - Companies, media, and governments use this data to understand behaviour, trends, and make decisions.
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Key Points:

- Helps companies in targeted advertising (showing the right ad to the right person).
 - Media houses know which topics are trending.
 - Governments use it for policy-making and disaster response.
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5. Unparalleled Benefits of the Net and Social Media:

- **Information access:** News, books, videos, education material available anytime.
 - **Communication:** Calls, video chats, messages – all free and fast.
 - **Business and jobs:** Online marketing, remote jobs, freelancing, startups.
 - **Social change:** People raise their voices, run campaigns, and support causes.
 - **Emergency help:** Quick information during floods, earthquakes, or health crises.
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Example:

- During the COVID-19 pandemic, people attended online classes, worked from home, and stayed connected through video calls.
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6. Largest Ungoverned Space on Earth:

- The internet has **no single owner**. It is used across countries without borders.
 - No government fully controls the entire internet.
 - Some platforms like Facebook or YouTube make their own rules.
 - This freedom also leads to **misuse** – like cybercrime, fake news, trolling.
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Key Points:

- There is **no international law** that controls the whole web.
 - Some websites host illegal or harmful content.
 - It is hard to catch criminals who hide behind fake names and IDs.
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7. Dark Net:

- **Dark Net** is a hidden part of the internet that is not available through normal browsers.
 - People need special software like **Tor** to access it.
 - It is used for both **good and bad** purposes.
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Key Points:

- Good uses: Journalists and activists use it to protect their identity.
 - Bad uses: Illegal trade, weapons, drugs, child abuse, hacking, and terrorism.
 - It is difficult for police to track people on the dark net.
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Example:

- Many illegal markets like **Silk Road** were shut down by authorities, but new ones still appear in the dark net.
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Conclusion:

The web has changed the world forever. It made communication faster, brought knowledge closer, and gave power to ordinary people. But with great power comes great responsibility. The ungoverned nature of the internet and the danger of the dark net remind us that we must use this powerful tool wisely, carefully, and ethically.

C. Different usages of new media technologies: E-learning, Web commerce, video conference and virtual presentation:

1. Definition:

- **New Media Technologies** are modern digital tools and platforms that help in sharing, creating, and receiving information using the internet, computers, and mobile devices.
 - Examples: websites, apps, social media, online learning platforms, video meeting tools, and e-commerce sites.
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2. E-Learning (Electronic Learning):

Definition:

E-learning means learning with the help of electronic devices and internet. It includes online classes, digital study materials, and virtual exams.

Key Points:

- Students can attend classes from anywhere.
- Study materials like notes, videos, and quizzes are available online.
- Learning apps and websites make studies easier and more interactive.

Example:

During the COVID-19 lockdown, students in Malda attended online classes using Google Meet, Zoom, and YouTube videos.

3. Web Commerce (E-commerce):

Definition:

Web commerce or e-commerce means buying and selling goods or services using the internet.

Key Points:

- People can shop online using websites and apps like Amazon, Flipkart, and Meesho.
- Sellers can do business without opening physical shops.
- It includes online payment, digital marketing, and customer reviews.

Example:

A small business owner from Kaliachak can sell handmade bags across India through Amazon or WhatsApp Business.

4. Video Conference:

Definition:

Video conference is an online meeting where people can see and talk to each other in real-time using video and audio.

Key Points:

- Saves time and travel costs.
- Useful for office meetings, webinars, interviews, and online classes.
- Popular platforms: Zoom, Google Meet, Microsoft Teams.

Example:

Journalism students of Aliah University attend online seminars with guest speakers using Zoom.

5. Virtual Presentation:

Definition:

A virtual presentation is a digital way of showing information to an audience using slides, videos, and voice through the internet.

Key Points:

- Used in education, office work, and training programs.
- Presenters use PowerPoint, Canva, Prezi, or Google Slides.
- Makes complex topics easy to understand with visuals and audio.

Example:

A student gives a PowerPoint presentation on 'Folk Media in Malda' during an online class using Google Meet.

Conclusion:

New media technologies have made life easier, faster, and smarter. E-learning, e-commerce, video conferencing, and virtual presentations help people study, work, and grow from any place at any time. These tools have changed the way we learn, communicate, and do business in the digital age.

Unit: 2

A. Multimedia, Hypertext, Interactivity, Archives and Virtuality:

1. Multimedia

Definition:

Multimedia means using more than one form of media (like text, image, audio, video, and animation) together in a single platform to communicate a message.

Key Points:

- It makes content more attractive and easy to understand.
- Used in education, journalism, advertisements, websites, and films.
- Can be interactive or non-interactive.

Example:

A news website showing text, photos, videos, and graphics about a flood in Malda district is an example of multimedia journalism.

2. Hypertext

Definition:

Hypertext is a type of digital text that contains links (called hyperlinks) to other texts, websites, videos, or pages.

Key Points:

- Readers can jump from one topic to another by clicking on links.
- It gives access to related information easily.
- Mostly used in websites, blogs, and digital documents.

Example:

In Wikipedia, words written in blue are hypertext links. Clicking on “Malda district” opens a new page with more information about it.

3. Interactivity

Definition:

Interactivity means two-way communication where the user can take part in the content instead of just reading or watching passively.

Key Points:

- The user can click, comment, react, share, or control the content.
- It increases user engagement and learning.
- Found in websites, games, social media, and apps.

Example:

A student answering quizzes in an online class app, or a person commenting on a news post on Facebook.

4. Archives

Definition:

Archives are a collection of past records, documents, images, videos, or news that are stored digitally or physically for future use.

Key Points:

- Help to preserve historical data.
- Useful for researchers, students, and journalists.
- Can be found in libraries, websites, and cloud storage.

Example:

The Press Information Bureau (PIB) website stores old government press releases in its archive section.

5. Virtuality

Definition:

Virtuality means something that is not physically real but experienced through computer-generated simulation, often using the internet or special devices.

Key Points:

- Gives a feeling of “being there” without actually going.
- Used in virtual reality (VR), games, online meetings, and digital tours.
- Helps in learning, training, and entertainment.

Example:

During the pandemic, people used Zoom for virtual classes and museums offered virtual tours online.

Conclusion:

In today’s digital world, multimedia, hypertext, interactivity, archives, and virtuality play a big role in communication, education, and media. They make information more engaging, easy to access, and meaningful for users. These tools have changed how we learn, share, and experience the world.

B. Digital Tools for Journalists (Document Cloud - Drop Box, Overview, Timelines, Wordle, etc.):

1. Definition:

Digital tools for journalists are software, apps, or websites that help journalists collect, organize, verify, analyze, and present news in an easier and faster way using technology.

These tools help in:

- Investigative reporting
 - Data journalism
 - Fact-checking
 - Content creation
 - File storage and sharing
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2. Important Digital Tools:

(i) Document Cloud

Definition:

Document Cloud is an online tool that allows journalists to **upload, analyze, search, highlight, and share documents** (like PDFs, reports, or legal papers) in a public or private way.

Key Points:

- Used in investigative journalism.
- Highlights key sections of long documents.
- Supports transparency in journalism.

Example:

A journalist uploads a government report to DocumentCloud and highlights parts related to corruption for the readers.

(ii) Drop box

Definition:

Drop box is a **cloud storage service** that allows journalists to store, access, and share files like photos, videos, articles, and documents safely from any device.

Key Points:

- Keeps backup of files.
- Useful for team collaboration.
- Supports large file transfer.

Example:

A reporter from Malda working with a Kolkata editor can upload interview videos to Drop box for easy access.

(iii) Overview

Definition:

Overview is a **data analysis and document mining tool** used by journalists to search and find patterns in large sets of text documents.

Key Points:

- Helps in sorting thousands of documents quickly.
- Useful in RTI reports, court papers, and leaked documents.
- Saves time and effort in research.

Example:

When a journalist receives 500 pages of RTI documents, Overview helps to find the most important words and topics easily.

(iv) Timelines (Timeline JS)

Definition:

Timeline JS is a free tool that allows journalists to create **interactive timelines** using dates, text, images, and videos.

Key Points:

- Good for explaining events over time.
- Visual and easy to understand.
- Used in digital storytelling.

Example:

A journalist creates a timeline of COVID-19 cases in Malda district showing important dates, images, and actions taken.

(v) Wordle

Definition:

Wordle is a tool that creates **word clouds** — visual displays of the most frequent words in a text.

Key Points:

- Helps in quick analysis of speeches, interviews, or articles.
- Bigger words mean more frequent usage.
- Useful in content analysis.

Example:

A journalist makes a Wordle of the Prime Minister's speech to see which words were used the most.

3. Other Useful Digital Tools for Journalists:

Tool	Use
Google Docs	Writing and sharing stories with team
Canva	Designing posters, social media posts
Grammarly	Checking spelling and grammar
Twitter/X	Breaking news and audience engagement
Google Trends	Finding trending topics for stories
FactCheck.org	Verifying fake news and claims

Conclusion:

Digital tools have made journalism faster, smarter, and more effective. Tools like DocumentCloud, Dropbox, Overview, TimelineJS, and Wordle help journalists collect, organize, and present news in a better way. In today's digital world, a journalist must know how to use these tools to stay updated and produce quality content.

C. Overview of open-source culture and software, Open Source Licenses (Creative Commons):

1. What is Open-Source Culture?

Definition:

Open-source culture is a way of thinking where people **freely share knowledge, tools, software, and creative works** with others so that anyone can use, improve, or share them.

Key Points:

- It supports **freedom, collaboration, and transparency**.

- People from different parts of the world work together on one project.
- It is used in **software development, education, journalism, art**, and more.

Example:

Wikipedia is an open-source knowledge website. Anyone can read, edit, or add information to it.

2. What is Open-Source Software?

Definition:

Open-source software is software whose **source code is freely available**. Anyone can use it, change it, and share it with others without paying money.

Key Points:

- Encourages innovation and teamwork.
- Usually free of cost.
- Maintained by a community of developers.
- Helps small organisations and students.

Popular Examples:

- **Linux** (operating system)
 - **Mozilla Firefox** (web browser)
 - **LibreOffice** (office software)
 - **Audacity** (audio editing)
 - **GIMP** (image editing)
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3. Benefits of Open-Source Software:

- **Free to use:** No need to buy licenses.
- **Customizable:** Users can change it according to their needs.
- **Secure and reliable:** Bugs are fixed quickly by the community.
- **No dependency on one company.**

Example:

A journalist in Malda can use Audacity (open-source software) to edit voice recordings for free instead of buying expensive software.

4. What are Open-Source Licenses?

Definition:

Open-source licenses are **legal rules** that allow others to use, copy, change, or share open-source software or creative work **legally and fairly**.

These licenses **protect the rights of the original creator** while giving freedom to users.

5. Creative Commons License (CC License):

Definition:

Creative Commons (CC) is a **popular type of open license** that allows people to share their creative works (like photos, videos, articles, music) with some rights reserved.

It tells others what they **can and cannot do** with the work.

Types of Creative Commons Licenses:

License Type	What it Allows
CC BY	Anyone can use and change the work, but must give credit.

License Type	What it Allows
CC BY-SA	Use, share, or change but must credit and share under same license.
CC BY-ND	Can be used with credit, but no changes allowed.
CC BY-NC	Free to use with credit, but not for commercial use.
CC0 (Public Domain)	Anyone can use it freely without giving credit.

Example:

- A student downloads a Creative Commons image from a website like Pixabay and uses it in a college project by giving proper credit.

6. Difference between Open Source and Copyrighted Software:

Open Source	Copyrighted
Free to use and modify	Cannot be modified without permission
Shared with public	Controlled by company or creator
Encourages collaboration	Limits access and control

Conclusion:

Open-source culture and software have created a **new path for learning, sharing, and innovation**. It helps students, journalists, and developers use powerful tools without spending money. Creative Commons licenses give a legal way to share creative works. In today's digital world, open source promotes **freedom, creativity, and community development**.

D. Internet and Censorship, Privacy concerns, Security issues in using digital technology (Malware, Phishing, Identity, Thefts):

1. Internet and Censorship

Definition:

Censorship means **controlling or blocking** certain content on the internet by the government or other authorities to stop people from seeing or sharing it.

Key Points:

- Censorship is done to protect national security, stop fake news, hate speech, or offensive content.
- But too much censorship can reduce **freedom of speech** and **freedom of the press**.
- Journalists, social media users, and creators may face limitations.

Example:

If a news website writes against a political leader and it gets blocked by the government, that is an act of censorship.

2. Privacy Concerns

Definition:

Privacy means keeping our **personal information safe** and not sharing it without permission. On the internet, many apps and websites collect user data like name, location, browsing habits, photos, and contacts.

Key Points:

- Data may be misused by companies or hackers.
- Apps may track location or access camera/microphone secretly.
- People may lose control over their personal information.

Example:

A photo shared on Facebook may be saved and shared by unknown people without permission, which is a privacy issue.

3. Security Issues in Using Digital Technology

Digital technology brings many benefits, but it also brings risks like **hacking, viruses, online frauds**, etc.

A. Malware

Definition:

Malware means **malicious software** that is created to harm your device, steal data, or damage files.

Key Points:

- It can come from unsafe downloads or fake websites.
- May slow down the device or steal passwords.

Example:

A person downloads a free movie from an unknown site, and a malware virus enters their phone, deleting personal files.

B. Phishing

Definition:

Phishing is a **fraudulent way of stealing personal information** like bank details or passwords by pretending to be a trusted person or company.

Key Points:

- Often done through fake emails or SMS.
- Links look real but lead to fake websites.

Example:

You receive an email that looks like it's from your bank asking for your ATM PIN. If you enter it, your money could be stolen.

C. Identity Theft

Definition:

Identity theft means **someone uses your personal data** (like Aadhaar number, phone number, bank details, or name) without permission to commit fraud.

Key Points:

- Criminals open fake accounts using your identity.
- They may take loans or cheat others using your name.

Example:

If someone uses your Aadhaar card number to open a fake SIM card and commits a crime, you can get into trouble.

4. How to Stay Safe:

Problem	Solution
Malware	Use antivirus software, don't click on unknown links.
Phishing	Never share OTPs or passwords, check email source carefully.
Identity Theft	Keep Aadhaar, PAN, bank details safe and private.
Privacy Risk	Read app permissions before installing, avoid public Wi-Fi for sensitive work.

Conclusion:

The internet is a powerful tool, but it comes with risks like censorship, privacy loss, and security threats. Users should be careful while using digital technology. Awareness, safe habits, and legal protection are needed to stay safe in the online world.

E. Search engine optimization, Advertising on the Internet:

1. What is Search Engine Optimization (SEO)?

Definition:

Search Engine Optimization (SEO) is the process of **improving a website or article** so that it appears higher in search engine results like Google, Bing, or Yahoo when people search for something.

Key Points:

- SEO helps more people find your website.
- It increases website traffic without paying for ads.
- Uses keywords, quality content, and proper structure.

Main Techniques of SEO:

- **Keyword usage:** Using important words people often search (example: "Tourist places in Malda").
- **Headings and subheadings:** Organizing content clearly.
- **Meta description:** A short summary that appears in search results.
- **Backlinks:** Links from other websites to your site.
- **Mobile-friendly design:** Website must work well on phones.

Example:

A journalist writes a blog on "Top Mango Markets in Malda." If they use correct keywords and SEO techniques, it will show on the first page of Google when people search "Malda mango market."

2. What is Advertising on the Internet?

Definition:

Advertising on the Internet means promoting products, services, or content through **paid promotions** on websites, social media, apps, or search engines.

Key Points:

- Reaches large audiences quickly.
- Advertisers can target people by age, location, interest, etc.
- Can be image ads, video ads, text ads, or pop-ups.

Types of Internet Advertising:

1. **Search Engine Ads** – Appear at the top of Google search (marked “Ad”).
2. **Display Ads** – Banner ads on websites.
3. **Social Media Ads** – Ads on Facebook, Instagram, YouTube, etc.
4. **Video Ads** – Ads shown before or during videos.
5. **Email Marketing** – Sending promotional emails to people.
6. **Influencer Marketing** – Paying social media users to promote products.

Example:

When you search for “best smartphone under ₹15,000” on Google, some company ads appear at the top. That is search engine advertising.

Or when a clothing brand shows up while scrolling Facebook – that is social media advertising.

3. Benefits of SEO and Online Advertising:

SEO	Internet Advertising
Free traffic	Paid promotion
Long-term benefit	Fast results
Builds trust	Wide reach
Needs time and strategy	Can be expensive but quick

Conclusion:

SEO and internet advertising are two powerful tools in today’s digital communication. While SEO helps websites grow naturally through good content and structure, advertising helps reach people faster by paying for promotion. Journalists, bloggers, news portals, and businesses must learn both to survive and grow in the online world.

Unit: 3

A. Content writing:

1. Definition:

Content writing means **writing information or stories** for websites, blogs, newspapers, social media, or online platforms to **inform, entertain, or promote** something.

It includes writing for:

- Blogs and articles
 - News websites
 - Company websites
 - Social media posts
 - Advertisements
 - Product descriptions
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2. Key Points of Good Content Writing:

(i) Clear Purpose

The writer must know **why** they are writing – to inform, to sell, to entertain, or to educate.

(ii) Know the Audience

Use **simple words** if readers are common people; use professional terms if readers are experts.

(iii) Use of SEO (Search Engine Optimization)

Using **important keywords** helps the content show up in Google searches.

(iv) Proper Structure

Use **headings, subheadings, short paragraphs**, and bullet points for better understanding.

(v) Original and Engaging

Content must be **original** (not copied) and **interesting** to read. It should connect with readers.

(vi) Correct Grammar and Spelling

Language should be **clean and error-free**. Proper grammar builds trust.

3. Types of Content Writing:

Type	Description
Blog Writing	Writing articles for websites on different topics like travel, health, news, etc.
Copywriting	Writing short and catchy text for ads or products.
Technical Writing	Writing user guides or manuals for machines, software, or services.
Script Writing	Writing scripts for videos, YouTube, or social media reels.
News Writing	Writing reports and news stories for newspapers or online portals.

4. Example:

A content writer is working for a travel website. He writes a blog titled **“Top 5 Tourist Places in Malda”**. He uses short paragraphs, good pictures, and keywords like “Malda tourism,” “historical places in Malda,” etc.

This helps readers understand the topic and also improves Google ranking.

5. Skills Needed for Content Writing:

- Good grammar and vocabulary
 - Research ability
 - Creative thinking
 - Knowledge of digital tools (like Grammarly, Canva, WordPress)
 - Basic knowledge of SEO
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6. Importance in Today's Time:

- Every website or online business needs content.
 - Content writing is important for **digital marketing, education, journalism, and branding**.
 - It helps connect people with useful and trustworthy information.
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Conclusion:

Content writing is a powerful form of digital communication. It is used in websites, advertisements, news, education, and social media. A good content writer needs to write clearly, attractively, and with purpose. In the modern world, content writing is a growing career option for students and media professionals.

B. On-line writing style:

1. Definition:

Online writing style means the **special way of writing for the internet**, such as websites, blogs, social media, and news portals.

It is different from print writing because **online readers read quickly and mostly on screens**, like mobile phones or computers.

2. Key Features of Online Writing Style:

(i) Short and Simple Sentences

- Use **easy language** and **short paragraphs**.
- Avoid difficult or long words.
- Make the message clear in the first few lines.

Example:

Instead of writing — "The geographical location of Malda provides many advantages"

Write — "Malda's location gives it many benefits."

(ii) Use of Headlines and Subheadings

- Headlines must be **catchy** and **informative**.
 - Subheadings help break the content into parts.
 - Helps readers **scan quickly** and understand the structure.
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(iii) Bullet Points and Lists

- Use **bullet points or numbering** to show important points clearly.

- Makes content easy to **read and remember**.
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(iv) Use of Hyperlinks

- Online writing often includes **hyperlinks** (clickable links).
- Links guide readers to related articles, videos, or websites.

Example:

You can read more about [Malda tourism here](#).

(v) SEO-Friendly

- Use **keywords** that people often search on Google.
- Helps your article show up in search results.

Example keywords:

“Best street food in Malda,” “Historical places in West Bengal.”

(vi) Interactive Content

- Add **images, videos, emojis, infographics**, or comments sections.
 - Makes content more engaging and user-friendly.
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(vii) Mobile-Friendly Format

- Online content should be **easy to read on mobile phones**.
 - Use **larger fonts, short lines**, and **no big paragraphs**.
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3. Example:

A student writes an online blog on “Top 5 Things to Do in Malda.”

Wrong style (print style):

Malda is a district in West Bengal. It is famous for mangoes, historical monuments, and religious places. Many tourists come to visit... (long and slow).

Correct style (online style):

Top 5 Things to Do in Malda

- ☐ Visit the historical Gour city
 - ☐ Taste Malda mangoes
 - ☐ Explore Adina Mosque
 - ☐ Enjoy the riverside views
 - ☐ Shop at local markets
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4. Importance of Online Writing Style:

- Helps attract more readers.
 - Increases engagement and sharing.
 - Important for digital journalism, blogs, advertising, and education.
 - Suitable for fast, on-the-go reading.
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Conclusion:

Online writing style is different from traditional writing. It must be **simple, short, well-structured, and interactive**. A good online writer should think like a reader and create content that is clear, useful, and easy to read on any device. In today’s digital age, mastering the online writing style is a powerful skill for journalists, bloggers, and content creators.

Unit: 4

1. Computer Assisted Reporting (CAR) and Cyber Journalism

(A) Computer Assisted Reporting (CAR)

Definition:

Computer Assisted Reporting means using **computers and digital tools** to help journalists **collect, organize, analyze, and present information**.

Key Points:

- Journalists use **spreadsheets, databases, and software** to understand big data.
- Helps in **investigative journalism** and **data journalism**.
- Makes reports more accurate and fast.

Example:

A journalist uses Excel to analyze thousands of government records to find corruption in a public health scheme.

(B) Cyber Journalism (Online Journalism)

Definition:

Cyber journalism means **publishing news and articles on the internet** through websites, social media, blogs, and apps.

Key Points:

- News is **updated instantly**.
- Allows **multimedia use** – text, images, audio, video.
- Readers can **comment, share, and interact**.
- No printing cost; wider global reach.

Example:

A reporter from Malda updates a flood news story with live videos and photos on a news portal like *Khabar Setu*.

2. Types of Social Media and Future in Journalism

(A) Types of Social Media:

Type	Examples	Use in Journalism
Social Networking Sites	Facebook, LinkedIn	Share news, build audience
Microblogging	Twitter (X), Koo	Breaking news, live updates
Photo/Video Sharing	Instagram, YouTube	Visual journalism
Messaging Apps	WhatsApp, Telegram	Quick news alerts
Blogs and Forums	WordPress, Medium	Personal reports, opinion pieces

(B) Future of Social Media in Journalism

Key Points:

- Journalists will use AI and **real-time tools** to cover news faster.
- **Citizen journalism** will grow – common people reporting news.
- More use of **short videos, live streaming, and interactive posts**.

- Journalists must fight **fake news** and protect digital ethics.

Example:

A journalist uses Instagram Reels to show behind-the-scenes of a political rally in real time.

3. Fake News and Disinformation

Definition:

- **Fake News** = News that is **completely false or misleading**, made to spread lies or confusion.
- **Disinformation** = **Planned spreading of false information**, often for political or business purposes.

Key Points:

- Fake news spreads quickly through WhatsApp, Facebook, etc.
- Can cause **fear, hate, riots, or political influence**.
- Journalists must **verify** every fact before publishing.

How to Identify Fake News:

- Check the **source** of the news.
- Look for spelling errors or emotional language.
- Verify from **trusted news websites**.

Example:

A WhatsApp message says "a school has been closed due to bomb threat" – but it's completely false. This is fake news.

4. Convergence of Media

Definition:

Media convergence means **joining different types of media** (print, TV, radio, internet) into **one digital platform**.

Key Points:

- Print media also appears on websites and apps.
- TV news is also streamed online.
- A single journalist now works with **text, video, and audio**.

Types of Convergence:

1. **Technological convergence** – using mobile, internet, apps for all media.
2. **Professional convergence** – one journalist doing writing, photography, and video.
3. **Content convergence** – same news shown on TV, website, and YouTube.

Example:

A news story about an election is written in a newspaper, discussed on a podcast, shown on YouTube, and updated on the news app.

Conclusion:

Unit IV shows the new face of journalism in the digital age. Journalists now use **computers, the internet, and social media** to gather and spread news quickly. While this has many benefits, it also brings **challenges like fake news, privacy, and fast fact-checking**. Understanding new media tools and using them responsibly is the future of good journalism.